Additionally, the *Manusmriti* and other *Dharmashastras* had considerable influence overseas, including in parts of Southeast Asia. [24]

The imprint of Indian culture is still discernible in the origins of most Southeast Asian scripts and writing systems and the exchange of folktales. The impact of Hinduism is evident in such places as Cambodia, Java, and Bali and in the littoral of the South China Sea. Trading links were strong: records from the third-century point to a thriving exchange of commodities (including horses) between India and today's Vietnam. The references in Indian writings to *Ratnadvipa*, *Agadvipa*, *Yamadvipa*, and *Suvarnadvipa* are associated with Sri Lanka, Malaya, Sumatra and Southeast Asia respectively. [25] The massive Hindu temple complex at Angkor Wat in today's Cambodia was constructed in the twelfth century. Similarly, the Champa culture in central and southern Vietnam showed the sustained influence of Hinduism throughout much of the first millennium and up to the thirteenth century. The imprint of Indian literature and mythology on Indonesian and Thai art, architecture, language, and folklore is strongly evident. Hindu iconography can still be found in the remains of temples in southern China on the Taiwan Strait.

If Hinduism and Buddhism spread in a south-eastern direction, the influence was no less to the north-east. Under the Pala Dynasty in what is present-day Bihar and Bengal, perhaps the last major flourishing of political Buddhism took place in India south of the Himalayas, which saw the establishment of universities at Nalanda, Vikramashila and Odantapuri. From these centres of learning, Buddhist art, icons, texts and ideas sometimes escaped destruction, reaching Kathmandu and Tibet. The influence of Indian Buddhism on Tibet cannot be overstated, including the large-scale import and translation of Sanskrit texts. The great Tibetan ruler-benefactor Trisong Detsen invited prominent Buddhist philosophers from India such as Santarakshita of Nalanda. [26] Via China and Southeast Asia, there were early associations of India with Korea and Japan, such as the legendary Korean queen Heo Hwang-ok who was said to have come from Ayodhya. According to Japanese chronicles, the South Indian Bodhisena travelled to China in the eighth century, where he met a delegation from